DISPEL MAGIC (5E, 2024 RULES) – DESCRIPTION

Level 3 – Abjuration
Casting Time: Action · Range: 120 feet
Components: V, S · Duration: Instantaneous
Classes: Bard, Cleric, Druid, Paladin, Ranger, Sorcerer, Warlock, Wizard

Choose one creature, object, or magical effect within range. Any ongoing spell of **level 3 or lower** on the target ends. For each ongoing spell of **level 4 or higher**, make an ability check using your spellcasting ability (DC 10 + the spell's level): on a success, the spell ends.

Higher-level slot: a spell whose level is equal to or less than the slot's level ends automatically.

🎲 Quick summary:

1. You target a creature, object, or effect within 120 ft.
2. Level 3 or lower spells: end automatically.
3. Level 4 or higher: check (DC 10 + level).
4. Higher slot: automatic end up to its level.

⚠ Flaw in the rule and fixes Table rule

The text doesn't say how you know which spells are active on the target. Fix: the DM announces whether active spells can be seen (see **Identifying a Spell**).

💡 Narrative option: Table rule

The DM can describe a burst of white light snuffing out runes and unraveling enchantments.

Step 1 – Choose the target:

A creature, object, or magical effect within 120 ft.

Step 2 – Level 3 or lower:

Any ongoing spell of level 3 or lower on the target ends.

Step 3 – Level 4 or higher:

Check with your spellcasting ability, DC 10 + the spell's level; success: the spell ends.

Step 4 – Higher-level slot:

A spell whose level is equal to or less than the slot ends automatically.

Example: Hugo (Wisdom +3) casts Dispel Magic on an ally under Hold Person (level 2): the spell ends automatically. Against a level 5 spell, he needs a check of 15 or higher.

DISPEL MAGIC (5E, 2024 RULES) – Q&A AND DEBATE

⚠ Common questions:

Which spells are dispelled?
All ongoing spells on the target, by level.

Is a check needed?
For level 4 or higher spells: DC 10 + the spell's level.

Which slot gives an automatic end?
A slot equal to or higher than the spell's level.

Can it dispel an instantaneous spell?
No: nothing left to dispel.

Does it dispel Wild Shape?
No: it affects only spells.

Can it replace Counterspell?
No: it can act only after the spell.

What is the range?
120 ft.

Does it work on an object?
Yes, on a magic object within range. Table rule

⚠ Debate points and table options:
Table rule

Instantaneous spells
An instantaneous spell has nothing left to dispel once cast. **Option**: follow the text.

Several spells
The spell works on all ongoing spells on the target. **Option**: keep it.

Zones and barriers
Dispelling a barrier doesn't cancel the effects inside. **Option**: keep it.

Magic items
Magic items' effects are magical effects. **Option**: the DM decides.

Readied casting
A readied dispel can act only after the spell. **Option**: keep it.

⚠ Rule clarifications (answers found on the web, reworded):

Non-spell features
The spell affects only spells: it doesn't end an effect like Wild Shape, unless the DM decides otherwise.

Instantaneous spells
An instantaneous spell has no ongoing effect to dispel once cast (for example a creature made by Animate Dead).

Barriers and effects
Dispelling can end a barrier, but not the magical effects inside. On a spell like Bless, it ends it only on the targeted creature.

Readied Dispel
A readied Dispel doesn't replace Counterspell: it can end a spell only after it has taken effect.

These points remain open to discussion: your feedback is welcome to refine this sheet.

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